CMC'S OUTDOOR GEAR RENTAL PROGRAM

A COMMUNITY BASED SOCIAL MARKETING CAMPAIGN

BY: CASSADIE MEFFERD

April 29th, 2025

PURPOSE/MISSION

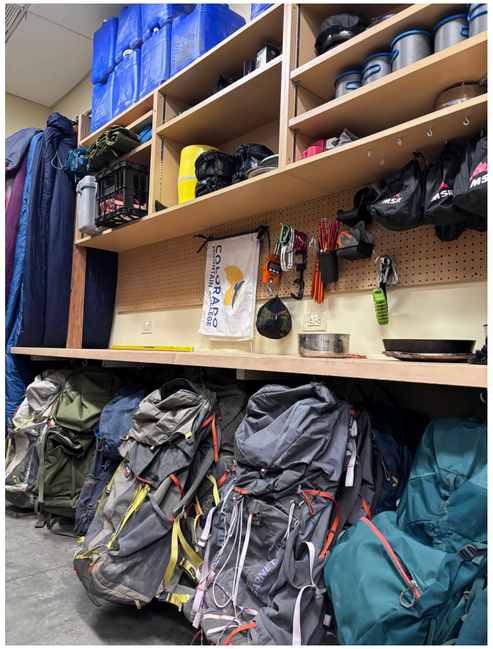
Outdoor recreation is can be difficult to become involved in because of the initial expense of gear. I hope to make playing in the outdoors accessible to all regardless of financial income, and to encourage those who haven't gotten out in the backcountry very much to have that opportunity. I also hope to inspire others to think more sustainably.



MY PHILOSOPHY

I believe that if people have positive experiences with nature that they will care about protecting it more.



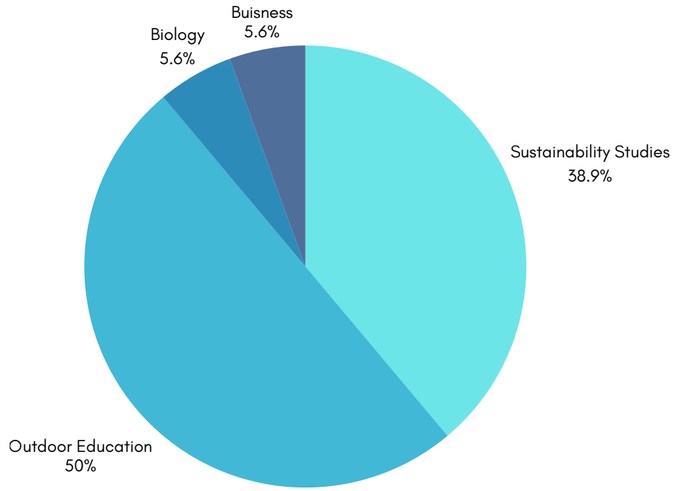


BENEFITS

- Save money
- Reduce individual consumption
- Increase access for students to get outdoors
    - experiences in nature build care for the environment

Initial Survey

What degree program are you in?

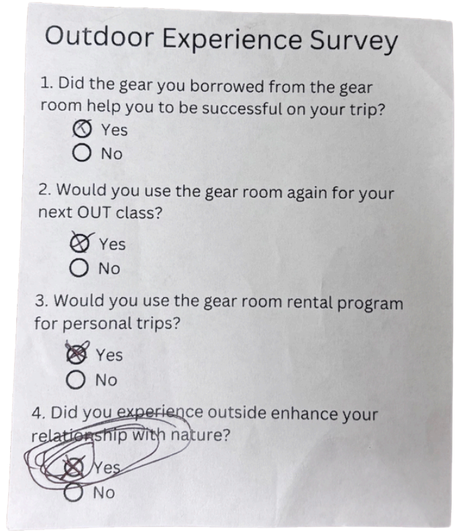


to track demographic/target audience

Would you be interested in using the Gear Room rental program for your personal trips?

100%

I asked students to fill out this quick questionare when they returned gear



Outdoor Experience Survey

1. Did the gear you borrowed from the gear room help you to be successful on your trip?
   - (X) Yes
   - ( ) No
2. Would you use the gear room again for your next OUT class?
   - (X) Yes
   - ( ) No
3. Would you use the gear room rental program for personal trips?
   - (X) Yes
   - ( ) No
4. Did you experience outside enhance your relationship with nature?
   - (X) Yes
   - ( ) No

to see if people would be interested

Did your experience outside enhance your relationship with nature?

Outdoor Opportunities help Students to...

- form deep emotional connections in nature
- increase awareness
- refocus and connect
- reflect and grow
- learn from nature
- feel a shared sense of responsibility
- witness environmental impacts

"Yes! Getting out into the backcountry has allowed me to see nature in its purest form and how it has been impacted by climate change, so now I feel compelled to protect it."

14 students Responded

Key Stats:

93% of students have used the gear room for an OUT class

86% felt that borrowing gear made them feel more sustainably conscious

72% currently have all of the gear they need for backpacking (28% doesnt)

72% said the borrowing from the gear room has influenced them to not purchase new gear

What would encourage you to use the Gear Room more often?

"A gear rental program"

"If I could use the gear room for personal use."

"if we didn't need a class to use it"

"Spread awareness of its awesomeness!!"

"Longer hours"

"Sell it to students when it's time to replace the gear, I'd be excited to use it beforehand so that I can anticipate that"

"More gear available like rafting stuff"

"Newer cooler gear."

"Accessibility. Gear variety"

"I have a lot of my own gear so don't use gear room that often"

What types of outdoor gear would you like to see available in the Gear Room?

GEAR WISH LIST

- Rafting gear (rafts, packrafts, PFDs, dry bags)
- canyoneering gear
- Touring skis / splitboards
- Water filters, daypacks, Jetboils, chairs, headlamps
- High-quality gear to try before buying



Balancing Gear Dreams with Safety + Feasibility

Students want items like rafts and climbing gear, but these come with liability concerns.

Why some items aren't currently offered:

Could require certifications and safety training
School liability limitations
Storage, maintenance, and supervision challenges

What We Can Do:

Expand low-risk gear options (more backpacking gear)
Consider partnering with local outfitters for rafting/canyoneering rentals

Promotional Efforts

POSTERS

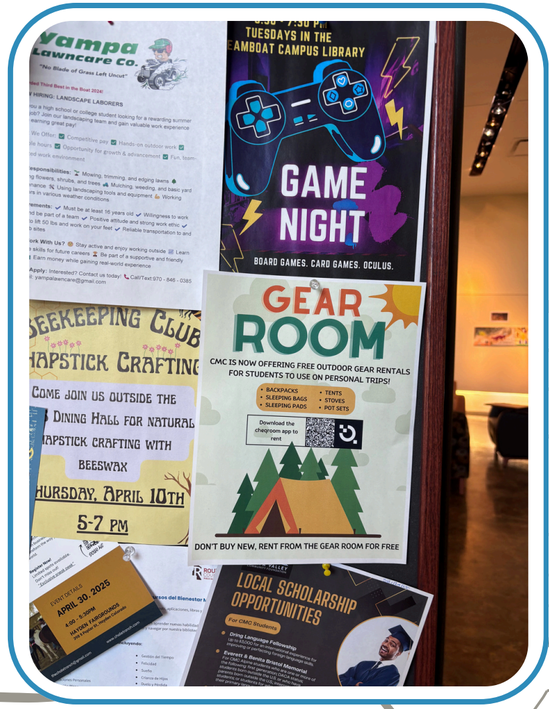


specific messaging



HUNG POSTERS ALL AROUND CAMPUS:

- Academic Building
  - OUT class (SB 213)
  - Gear Room door
- Bristol Hall
- Student Apartments
- Dorms



WORD OF MOUTH

I got a lot of people to download the app (10), but only 2 actually used it...

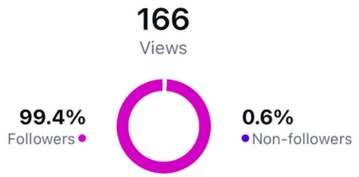




COLLEGE-WIDE TEXTS

did you know the gear room is now offering FREE rentals for students? Download the 'Cheqroom' app to reserve backpacking gear. We have backpacks, tents, sleeping bags, pads, stoves, and pot sets. So what are you waiting for? Let's go camping!

SOCIAL MEDIA



166 views
10 likes
2 replies

WIN FREE RAFFLE TICKETS

DOWNLOAD THE CHEQROOM APP AND RESERVE GEAR FROM CMC'S GEAR ROOM TO WIN A FREE RAFFLE TICKET



conditions: you must actually use this gear to get outside in nature.

WHY NOT PLAN A SPONTANEOUS CAMPING TRIP THIS WEEKEND? SEEMS LIKE A GOOD EXCUSE TO GO ON AN ADVENTURE





INCENTIVE:

WIN A FREE RAFFLE TICKET IF YOU DOWNLOAD THE APP AND RESERVE GEAR!

IT ALMOST WORKED! UGH

CHALLANGES:

Technical Difficulties :(

Student Testimonials

1. How did the Gear Room help support your outdoor adventures?

"The Gear Room helped support my outdoor adventures by providing shelter and a sleeping pad. These items greatly enhanced my trip and provided for a wonderful learning experience." - Harrison

"The gear rental program helped support me on many outdoor side quests, I would not have been able to get outside without a reliable backpack from the gear room due to financial reasons." - Klara



2. Has the rental program made you think differently about how or what you consume when it comes to outdoor gear?

"The rental program has definitely made me think differently about how and what I consume when it comes to outdoor gear. Where possible, I don't want to be using more gear than is necessary, and this rental program is a perfect example of that." - Harrison

"Absolutely, it showed me what I wanted out of a backpack and helped me make an educated choice when I did purchase a pack!" - Klara



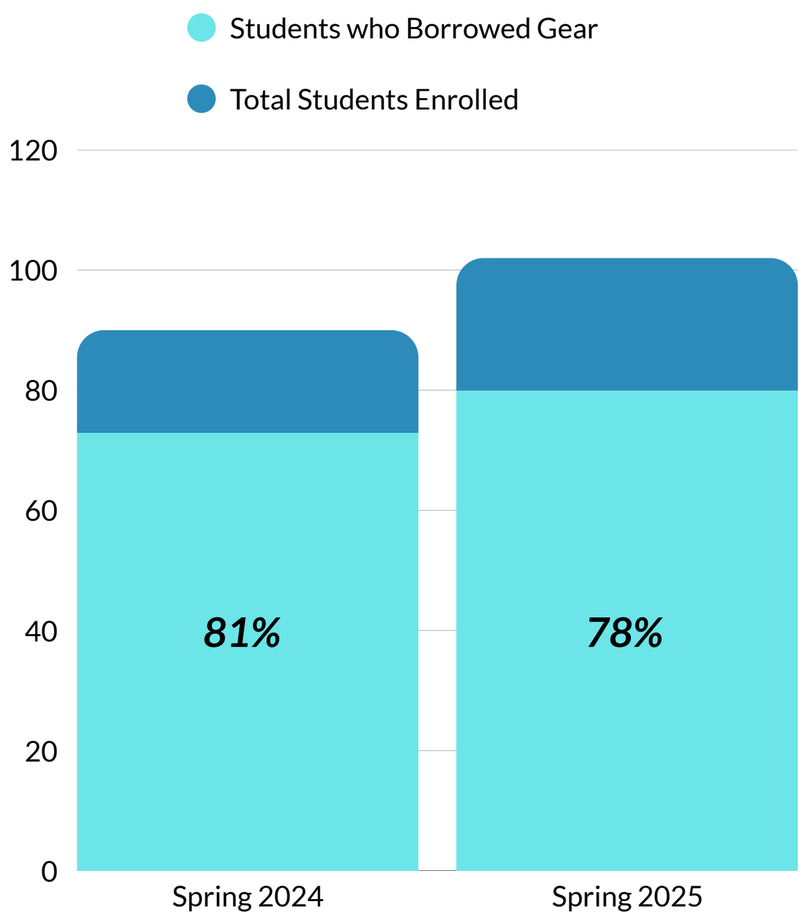
3. Would you use the Gear Room Rental Program again, or is there anything you'd like to see added or improved?

"I would definitely use the Gear Room Rental Program again, it drastically reduces consumption and it connects students with a wider community. I can't think of anything I'd like added or improved, it is a wonderful resource!" - Harrison

"I'll definitely use it again!!! The only thing I'd want to see would be summer rental options" - Klara

Results

QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS (MEASURED BEHAVIOR SHIFT)



Although the total number of students enrolled in OUT classes, and who borrow gear, has increased, the percentage of students borrowing gear has gone down. Perhaps this is because returning students are acquiring more of their own gear.

If I add the two students who rented gear, then the percentage goes up!

QUALITATIVE ANALYSIS (OBSERVED BEHAVIOR SHIFT)

Strategies that worked best:

- spreading the word - telling my friends
- social media posts

What didn't:

- technical difficulties
- time of year

What I Learned from the Process

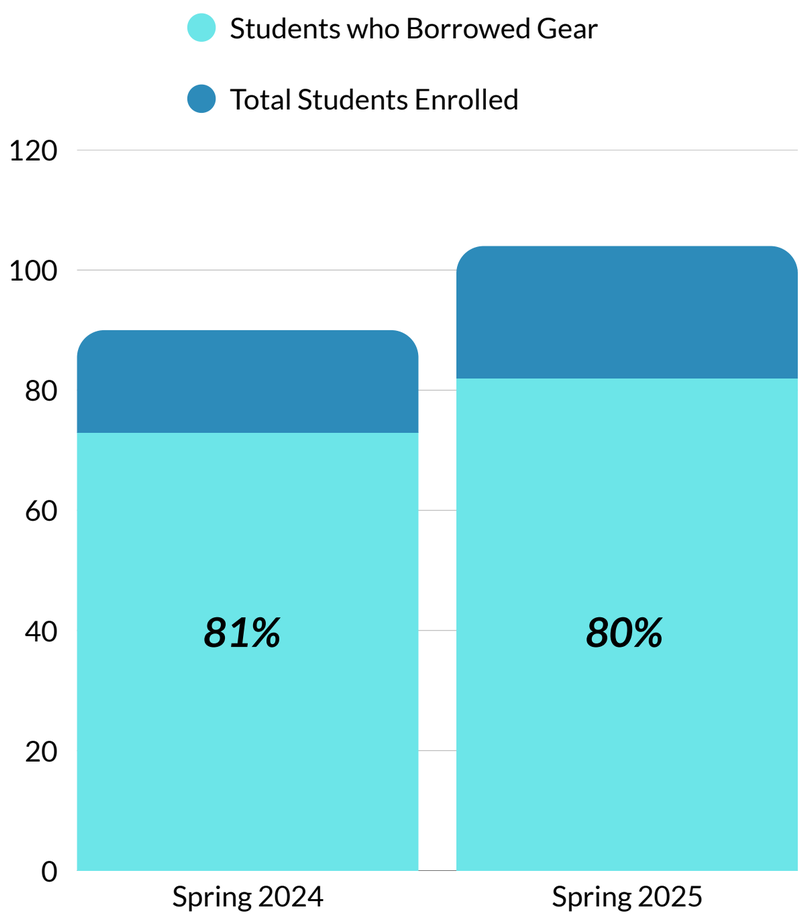
- not everything goes according to plan, and thats okay!
- sometimes you have to be annoyingly persistent

My Advice

- don't beat yourself up if you don't feel momentum right away
- be adaptable and willing to shift

Results

QUANTITATIVE ANALYSIS (MEASURED BEHAVIOR SHIFT)



Although the total number of students enrolled in OUT classes, and who borrow gear, has increased, the percentage of students borrowing gear has gone down. Perhaps this is because returning students are acquiring more of their own gear.

If I add the two students who rented gear, then the percentage goes up!

QUALITATIVE ANALYSIS (OBSERVED BEHAVIOR SHIFT)

Strategies that worked best:

- spreading the word - telling my friends
- social media posts

What didn't:

- technical difficulties
- time of year

What I Learned from the Process

- not everything goes according to plan, and thats okay!
- sometimes you have to be annoyingly persistent

My Advice

- don't beat yourself up if you don't feel momentum right away
- be adaptable and willing to shift

The Future of the Gear Room

WHAT STUDENTS WANT

MORE GEAR	Rafting gear, backcountry skis, headlamps. Potentially lawn games like cornhole and spike ball
MORE HOURS	Available during the Summer Possible once we hire more staff

WHAT I WANT

OPEN RENTALS UP TO THE COMMUNITY	be able to offer gear to anyone! also collaborate with Yampatika
PARTNERS	Big Agnes, NRS, MSR, Backdoor Sports
GEAR REPAIR WORKSHOP	new sewing machine in the library, and no-sew patches